

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Anne E. Dote

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Anne E. Dote

Director of Education & Docent Programs

Anne can make a school group care about a pot shard. Tonight's donors are proving harder.

- Coaches **Reed DeLabel** through gallery tours. **Reed** keeps adding footnotes to the children's handouts.
- Turns **Claire O'Scuro**'s research into tours people can follow. **Claire** keeps restoring the difficult words.
- Invites **Justin Tyme** to speak about Tulsa history. She now reviews his slides before inviting donors.

ACTING TIPS

Engaging, practical, empathetic, irreverent about institutional pomp.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Anne E. Dote. I run education here. I can make almost anything interesting, including a room full of adults behaving badly.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Anne E. Dote

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant's gift conditions would cut public education programming to fund a private donor lounge and VIP entrance.

Your other secret

You organized an anonymous staff petition against the plan and slipped copies into trustee folders.

Conversations to start

- Ask Anya Tique whether she will defend the education program against a donor lounge.
- Ask Claire O'Scuro what ordinary visitors would lose if education funding disappeared.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anne E. Dote

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *The mirror has a secret that never appears in its reflection. Look above the glass.*
- 2 *The artwork is innocent; something behind it deserves questioning.*
- 3 *A Bible contains a small addition that is not part of scripture.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Anne E. Dote

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The anonymous petition was mine. Grant wanted the education budget turned into a private lounge. I slipped copies into trustee folders. If trustees can spend an evening discussing champagne access, they can spend two minutes discussing children's access. I didn't request permission for the comparison.

IF MURDERER

I organized the petition and put it in the trustee folders. Grant threatened to cancel the program before it became an embarrassment. He thought children were an attractive subject for a brochure and an inconvenient population in a building. I had run out of gracious replies.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Anne E. Dote

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The puppet's loan tag was filed in preparation. I asked for it at the west counter and made the puppet complain about the wait. The assistant passed it through the slot; the puppet thanked him. We stayed in the corridor the whole time. That was our one errand to the department before the toast.

IF MURDERER

The puppet's loan tag had been filed with the installation materials. I used the east visitor door and fetched it from the shelves inside. I used its blank reverse for another petition signature. If Grant wanted fewer children in the museum, I intended to put more names in front of him. He disliked the handwriting almost as much as the arithmetic.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Anne E. Dote

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

When did that work or interruption end, and what were your materials used for?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What detail on the original paper or record confirms the sequence you described?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The tag says WEST RETURN. Its reverse now has another petition signature, acquired after the assistant handed it out. Grant proposed a workshop with his name on it while cutting the staff who would run it. The puppet is still waiting to hear how that works.

IF MURDERER

The tag is marked EAST VISITOR. I fetched it inside. My petition went to Grant afterward. A workshop bearing his name would not replace the staff and access his cuts removed. The puppet had a more sensible funding proposal.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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Anne E. Dote

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Anne E. Dote

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I used museum materials for a petition without permission. I will answer for that; I will also keep asking who the museum serves. My only preparation visit was a return-counter exchange outside the barrier. I could collect a loan tag there, not the sample on the visitor-side shelves. Grant's death will not restore the budget by itself.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the walkthrough and hid it in the puppet's cleaning cloth. While the glass was uncovered I brought Grant the petition and applied the solution inside his glass while spreading the signatures. I told myself I was defending a program. I was killing a person, and the children I invoked would recognize the difference.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.
